

County Council Meeting July 22nd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1HgElniqvfo
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Meeting Summary: Delaware County Council

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the regular meeting.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer. The meeting date referenced June 24th council minutes and upcoming budget hearings following Labor Day.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Brad Bookout, Dan Flanigan, William Hughes, Matt Kriz (noted as Kz/Can in transcript), Jessica Piper, Eugene Whitehead, Ben Freeman.
 - **Members Absent:** Jim Mo.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in the opening roll call, but leading the agenda proceedings.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The agenda posting was verified.
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **00:01:58** Motion to table the June 24th council minutes to allow staff (working with Marissa) to clean up AI-generated transcription errors using new prompts before the next meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Hughes: yes, Bookout: yes, Piper: yes, Can/Kriz: yes, Whitehead: yes).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:01 Appointment & Committee Reports: Redevelopment Commission Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Amber Green, President of the Delaware County Redevelopment Commission (DCRC), alongside new Executive Director Gina Caravalia.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Amber Green reported that recent project bids (such as the MIC trail extension and park entrance) are coming in significantly higher than engineer estimates, resulting in the park entrance project being put on hold. An interlocal agreement with Daleville was amended so DCRC retains 20% for countywide expenses. Updates were provided on the "Make My Move" workforce attraction program (expanded to in-state regional workers), Cowan schools security upgrades, highway equipment purchases, and gravel road paving. Gina Caravalia was introduced as the new Executive Director.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Information received; no board action required.
- **00:06:45 Job Classification & Compensation Committee: CASA Director Position**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Matt Kriz / Jeff Hanser (Chief Probation Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed updating the CASA Executive Director job description. Because candidates with a law degree were unsuccessful in filling the role, the description was modified to match the previously approved version minus the legal degree requirement. Jeff Hanser noted that Nikki Bosan (a CASA employee since 2017) was successfully hired into the directorship position.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made to update the CASA Executive Director job description. Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Bookout: yes, Chance/Kriz: yes, Whitehead: yes).
- **00:09:37 Financial Transfer: County General (Courts)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Judge (Presented by Elizabeth).

- **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer funds within County General (from Assistant Court Reporter line to Equipment) to purchase seven "Remarkable" electronic notepads for judges and magistrates at approximately \$650 each. The pads convert handwriting to typed text and automatically save to PDF for easy uploading into Odyssey, replacing physical paper pads. Total transfer: \$4,471 (supplemented by existing equipment funds).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Can/Kriz: yes, Whitehead: yes).
- **00:13:07 Financial Transfer: Cumulative Bridge (County Highway)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kerry, County Highway.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer \$25,000 from Health Insurance to Overtime Pay. Health insurance savings resulted from a retirement and replacement employee not requiring family coverage. Overtime is needed due to staff shortages, winter call-ins, high-seniority bridge crew call-in rates, payout of accumulated overtime for a retiring employee (Tommy), and aggressive pipe-replacement work prior to paving season.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Whitehead: yes, and others).
- **00:17:00 Financial Transfer: CASA Program**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Hanser, Chief Probation Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds originally allocated for a legally credentialed CASA director position. Because a non-attorney (Nikki Bosan) was hired, funds are reallocated to contractual services to hire an attorney as needed, and \$1,000 to an Adobe software subscription.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Bookout: yes, Whitehead: yes).
- **00:17:52 Addendum Transfer: Commissioners**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenna.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$2,956.88 from the Commissioner HR receptionist line to the executive administrator line to prevent the current line from going negative at year-end.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, Moel/Bookout: yes, Hughes: yes, Whitehead: yes).
- **00:18:53 Additional Appropriation: Delaware County Fair and Expo**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented on behalf of Donna.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$40,000 in Contractual Services for unencumbered payroll bills from the end of the previous year and summer part-time

worker compensation. Auditor confirmed a remaining surplus of approximately \$19,000 after this appropriation.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, and others).
- **00:20:48 Additional Appropriation: Statewide 911**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Fred.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$3,000 in Deputy Director salary line to cover payout for the departing deputy director while overlapping with the incoming deputy director.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Flanigan: yes, and others).
- **00:21:56 Additional Appropriation: Planning Commission (DMMPC)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylene Swakimer, Planning Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$10,000 in Contractual Services to establish a fund line for two grants received to update the Delaware County ADA transition plan (\$5,000 from Ball Brothers Foundation and \$5,000 from the Community Foundation).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Lanigan/Flanigan: yes, Hughes: yes, Bookout: yes, Piper: yes, Chance: yes).
- **00:23:02 Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance / Back-Filling Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve financial transfers and amend the salary ordinance with like reductions, followed by a motion to receive the back-filling report.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Both motions approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Old Business: Rainy Day Fund Discussion (00:34:00)**
 - Led by Bill Hughes and legal counsel Ben Freeman. Discussed utilizing a portion of excess Local Income Tax (LIT) supplemental distributions (specifically taking a \$466,000 excess over last year) to boost the Rainy Day Fund from its current balance of \$69,025 to approximately \$1.075 million. Legal counsel Ben Freeman

reported on State Board of Accounts and Attorney General guidance allowing transfers of unencumbered funds into rainy day funds provided an ordinance establishes a specific, defined purpose for the funds. Legal counsel was directed to draft an ordinance and review past ordinances for the next meeting.

- **New Business: Budget Hearing Schedule (00:38:16)**

- Budget hearings are scheduled for the Wednesday, Thursday, and Friday following Labor Day, starting at 8:00 a.m. each day. Detailed schedules are in development.

- **Elected Officials & Department Head Reports:**

- **Sheriff's Office (00:39:42 - Jeff Stanley & Nancy):** Provided a mid-year report. Meal costs under new vendor Invictus dropped to \$1.62 per meal (and will drop to \$1.59 if population exceeds 404). Pension funds are up 6.59% with a balance over \$24.3 million. Jail revenue from January to June reached \$818,336 (73% from federal inmates, exceeding the \$1 million annual estimate). State Department of Correction (DOC) is behind on housing payments. Commissary report details were reviewed.
- **Planning Commission (00:47:21 - Kylene Swakimer):** Provided an update on the ADA transition plan update covering eight county facilities. Public input sessions are scheduled (including August 6th at the EMA building, 210 S. Jefferson St.). A special Plan Commission meeting for the solar ordinance is scheduled for August 12th at 6:00 p.m. at the Justice Center.

- **Board Announcements:**

- Council members congratulated the fair board on a successful 4-H fair and community night.
- Matt Kriz reported on attending an Association of Indiana Counties seminar regarding Capital Improvement Plans (CIP) and noted upcoming township capital improvement mandates.

- **Adjournment:**

- **01:00:00** Motion to adjourn made by Piper, seconded by Flanigan. Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed Unanimously).
- **Next Meeting:** Tuesday, August 26 at 9:00 a.m.